

it had features it doesn't have—or you come across a bug, then add the feature or fix the bug and send the change to the developers of the program; then work with them to get your change installed. That is how you learn.

Q Increasingly the computing industry is shifting to tablets, which is a completely non-free ecosystem. What is the Free Software Foundation doing to make Free Software for tablets?

The Software Freedom Law Centre is looking for a way to fight against Microsoft's power trap. Meanwhile, we may arrange the development of, and sell some computers that are designed to work with free software. That's all we can do. There is a lot of free software to use. Android is released as free software, but it is not a complete system. There is always some other non-free software in it. But there is a version called Replicant, which can get rid of most of the non-free software on a few phone models. There are many Android devices that don't allow users to download software. And those parts of Android are not Free Software, and are licensed under the ASF (Apache Software Foundation) licence. Android is not free, but it is better than Microsoft's Windows Phone and Apple's iOS. Google has complied with the requirements of the GNU General Public License for Linux, but the Apache licence on the rest of Android does not require source release. Google has said it will never publish the source code of Android 3.0 (aside from Linux), even though executables have been released to the public. Android 3.1 source code is also being withheld. Thus, Android 3, apart from Linux, is non-free software, pure and simple.

RMS speaks on Facebook, Amazon and Steve Jobs...

Q You have expressed your rejection of Facebook. Why?

Facebook is not your friend, and is certainly not my friend. Facebook collects data on who was where, and when, and uses its so-called 'users' to collect its data. If you posted a photo of me in Facebook, people would be invited to label it as Richard Stallman—and their database will have more information about me. I don't want their database to have information about anybody.

Q Why have you asked your followers not to do business with Amazon through Stallman.org?

Amazon's Swindle is malware. That's not its official name, of course. I am talking of an e-book reader which is designed to swindle readers out of their traditional freedom of reading. There is a freedom to buy a book anonymously paying cash, which is the only way I buy books. I never give my name to be put in any database with the books I have bought; I don't want any database to have that information. With the Swindle, however, Amazon forces users to identify themselves to get identified with the books they have bought. Amazon has a giant database

that records each book that each user has read—and such a database, no matter who has it, is a threat to human rights. We must not allow that to exist.

Then there is a freedom to give a book to someone else, or to lend it to other people, or even to sell it, perhaps to a book store. Amazon eliminates those freedoms with digital handcuffs, together with end-user licence agreements. So Amazon goes far to show its contempt for the idea of private property. Users can't own books.

And there is also a freedom to keep a book for as long as you wish, and pass it on to your children.

“ If there is something that I can do only with proprietary software, I will rather not do it.”

Amazon abolishes this freedom with a back-door. We know about these back-doors by observation. In 2009, users observed that Amazon remotely deleted thousands of copies of a particular book. These were authorised copies, until they were wiped off by Amazon. The book was 1984 by George Orwell. The official name of the product is Kindle. Kindle means to start a fire. Evidently, this product was designed to burn our books—so don't let it happen! Don't ever use that product, or anything like it.

Q You have been reported to have said, “I am glad Jobs is gone.” People did not really understand what you meant. Please explain.

People distorted what I said. I said it's not good that he is dead, but it's good that he is gone. The reason I said it was because he was an evil genius, who did harm to the world. He figured out how to make computers that were prisons for the users, and he made them attractive, so that many users got attracted to the glamour, to be handcuffed. After he did this, Microsoft started doing the same thing. So he changed the world for the worse, and we are still fighting the harm that he did. That's the reason for what I said. Of the various things that Jobs did, that one is the most important, and he is a big harm to the world. I am glad he is not able to do any more of this. I hope that his successors will be less successful than him.

Q Why don't you use a cell phone?

Because cell phones can track my location or my conversation with anyone. Most cellular phones, even if they are not smartphones, do have a processor running software and that (proprietary) software is malware, because it will send information about its users' locations on remote command—and it has a back-door, so it can be remotely converted into a listening device. Almost all software has bugs—but this software is itself a bug. 